

The many desktop choices of Linux

One of our Quick Tips about [GNOME and KDE](#) etc, talks about the availability of *Window Managers* or *Desktop Environments*. Depending upon which Distribution of Linux you have (eg, Ubuntu, Fedora, elementaryOS), they ship with different default Desktop Environments. Ubuntu, Fedora and Debian (as well as hundreds of other Linux variants) ship with the GNOME desktop environment. Whereas OpenSUSE and many other Linux variants ship with KDE by default. Then there are other, generally more niche Linux distributions that ship with alternative window managers. LXDE (for low specification PCs), OpenBox, i3, AwesomeWM and xmonad are some examples.

Choice is a fantastic thing, but as a fledgling Linux user, this can also get confusing: which desktop environment is best? Which is easiest? What tools do one provide vs the other?

There is no one-size fits all answer, and that's why Linux users are spoiled for choice. However to make this chapter simple, I'm going to assume that you will be using the GNOME desktop. I've chosen GNOME because it's arguably the most popular Linux desktop environment available at the time of writing. It's definitely one of the easiest desktop environment's to use, and it looks nice too. GNOME has been around since 1999. Now on its 3rd major release, it has stood the test of the time.

All this said, remember, you are totally free to choose any Linux desktop you like. [Simply install it using your software installation tool](#) and try it out!